# Matthew Lau

Artist, Singapore

My work explores the relationship between people and machines through interactive light. Light is a medium that connects across different kinds of understanding, and through responsive lighting environments I turn abstract computational ideas into sensory experiences that can be felt before they are explained.

By making visible what usually stays hidden — the algorithms, processes and machine-learning principles that increasingly shape our world — the work pushes back on the idea of artificial intelligence as an inscrutable black box. Earlier pieces made latent spaces legible as colour and light. The newer ones ask what such a system does when it is left alone with itself, learning from its own output until its range collapses.

Underneath this is a belief that technology should deepen human connection rather than thin it out. The installations treat the machine as a collaborator rather than a tool, setting up a dialogue in which human intention and computational process both shape what is finally seen.

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Contact

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Portfolio

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LinkedIn

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## Group exhibitions

*Reconstructed Colours* 2026
*Techno Terra: Archive of the Future*, Gallery 1, Institute of Contemporary Arts Singapore

*Forms Drifting*, in collaboration with Neuewave/MDRN 2026
*I SAW IT, Singapore Art Week 2026*, Flock at Kampong Java, Singapore

*Circulated Densities* 2025
*Singapore: A Design Thesis in the Making*, Gallery 1, Institute of Contemporary Arts Singapore

*Deconstructed Ambiance* 2025
*Beyond Interface & Prompt: Exploring the Language of Technology in Contemporary Art*, WAH Center (Williamsburg Art & Historical Center), Brooklyn, New York

*Ambi(latent) Space* 2025
*to be CONTINUED – a work in progress show*, NYC Resistor, Brooklyn, New York

*Deconstructed Colours* 2023
*Threads: A Critical Craft Collective Experiment, Draft #2*, Earl Lu Gallery, Institute of Contemporary Arts Singapore

*The Oort Cloud and the Blue Mountain*, with Neuewave/MDRN, Andreas Schlegel & Hazel Lim-Schlegel 2022
*Singapore Art Week 2022*, Tanjong Pagar Distripark, Singapore

*ASICS Art in Motion Campaign* 2022
*Pop-up activation*, Alchemist, Design Orchard, Singapore

*NewWave* (shown as *Sea of Debris*), in collaboration with Neuewave/MDRN 2021
*Archifest 2021*, Singapore

*NewWave*, in collaboration with Neuewave/MDRN 2021
*Farewell To Reason, by (KSY) Nathan Yong*, Industry+, Singapore

*The Oort Cloud and the Blue Mountain*, with Neuewave/MDRN, Andreas Schlegel & Hazel Lim-Schlegel 2021–2022
*Kinderbiënnale 2021*, Groninger Museum, Groningen, Netherlands

*The Oort Cloud and the Blue Mountain*, with Neuewave/MDRN, Andreas Schlegel & Hazel Lim-Schlegel 2021–2022
*Children's Biennale 2021*, Japanisches Palais, Staatliche Kunstsammlungen Dresden, Germany

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## Education

### Master of Professional Studies, Interactive Telecommunications

*New York University, Tisch School of the Arts, ITP (New York)* 2023–2025

Thesis: *Ambi(latent) Space* — Edge Machine Learning for Adaptive Lighting Systems. IMDA SG Digital Postgraduate (Media) Scholarship.

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### BA (Hons) Design Communication, First Class Honours

*LASALLE College of the Arts (Singapore)* 2020–2022

Dissertation: *Hello, I'm Here* — Affective Computing Light Installation, from Affective Communication Research. LASALLE Scholarship.

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### Diploma in Design Communication, with Distinction

*LASALLE College of the Arts (Singapore)* 2014–2017

A foundation in design communication and core design principles, and in how design shapes cultural and social contexts.

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